

N01 FRUITS AND VEGETABLES | P

Intent : Promote the consumption of fruits and vegetables by increasing the availability and accessibility of fruits and vegetables.

Summary : This WELL feature requires the provision and promotion of fruits and vegetables, if food is sold or provided on a daily basis.

Issue : Fruits and vegetables are a key component of a healthy dietary pattern for the prevention of chronic disease.¹ However, most individuals around the world do not meet the daily recommended five servings (400 g).¹ Insufficient fruit and vegetable intake is attributed to 5.2 million deaths worldwide in 2013, as well as 14% of gastrointestinal cancer deaths, 11% of ischemic heart disease deaths and 9% of stroke deaths globally.² Greater consumption of fruits and vegetables is associated with a reduced risk of cardiovascular disease, obesity, type 2 diabetes, stroke and certain types of cancers, as well as improved weight management.^{1,3–5} Eating a variety of fruits and vegetables also helps to ensure adequate nutrient, micronutrient and dietary fiber intake.⁶

Solutions : Increasing the availability and access of fruits and vegetables can support fruit and vegetable consumption. Increased availability of fresh fruit at worksites has been shown to improve fruit and vegetable consumption at work and at home, indicating that individuals take these healthier habits home.⁷ Strategies to increase fruit and vegetable consumption include behavioral interventions, such as increased availability and visibility of fruits and vegetables, pricing incentives to lower the cost of fruits and vegetables and promotion and support of community gardens and urban agriculture initiatives.⁸

PART 1 PROVIDE FRUITS AND VEGETABLES

For All Spaces except Commercial Dining Spaces:

Option 1: Food offerings

Each food outlet meets one of the following requirements:

- a. The selection includes at least two different individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and at least two different individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.⁹
- b. At least 50% of available food options are individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and/or individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.

OR

Option 2: No food offerings

The following requirement is met:

- a. There are no foods sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner.

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

One of the following requirements is met:

- a. The selection includes at least four different individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and at least four different individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.¹⁰
- b. At least 50% of available food options are individually selectable fruit offerings (containing no added sugar) and/or individually selectable non-fried vegetable offerings.

PART 2 PROMOTE FRUIT AND VEGETABLE VISIBILITY

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Food offerings

Fruit and vegetable offerings sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner meet the following requirements:

a.

Fruit and vegetable offerings that are self-serve meet at least one of the following:

- i. Are located at eye-level or just below eye-level.^{9,11,12}
- ii. Are displayed on a countertop, table or other visible surface.¹³
- iii. Are located at point-of-sale or point-of-purchase.^{9,11,12}
- iv. Are located at the end of aisles.^{9,11,12}
- v. Are located at the beginning of food service lines.^{9,11,12}
- vi. Are visible from the food outlet entrance.¹⁴

b.

If food is prepared on-site and presented on menus (including digital menus and menu boards), fruit and vegetable offerings meet at least three of the following:

- i. Are included as default options throughout the menu.¹¹
- ii. Are listed using appealing descriptions.^{15,16}
- iii. Are visually highlighted through icons, different colors or bolding.¹⁷
- iv. Are listed first in each menu section.¹⁷
- v. Are listed in prominent areas of the menu (e.g., the top, bottom, corners).¹⁷

OR

Option 2: No food offerings

The following requirement is met:

- a. There are no foods sold or provided on a daily basis by (or under contract with) the project owner.

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